Evgenii Uvarov

Senior Backend Developer · Python

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Backend developer, writing Python since 2016, the last four years in payments and fintech. I usually own a service from the first commit through production and beyond: API contract, code, deployment, monitoring, incident response.

I care about the boring things: idempotent integrations, logs and traces you can actually debug with, and releases nobody notices.

Experience

Life Pay / Fortis · Jul 2022 — present
Backend Developer

Fortis (MENA): merchant self-service · 2024 — present

- On the team building self-service merchant onboarding on Temporal and Keycloak, from the first commit to the September 2025 release. Proposed extending the onboarding contract via JSON Schema stored in Vault. Built token exchange, magic links, OTP and Google sign-in, and multi-layer brute-force protection.
- Rewrote the Keycloak client on FastAPI with a gradual v2 cutover, and added API-key authorization for the Public API.
- Designed and built a tariff/entitlements gateway for POS terminals from scratch, and validated it in shadow mode on live traffic: request mirroring, diffing against the BFF in Prometheus and Grafana, chaos testing for failure handling.
- Built the pricing and subscriptions platform from the first AWS build to production in 2025; the lead backend developer on this track for over two years. In 2026, built billing and subscription add-ons.
- Built a file service from scratch and shipped it to production in 5 months, then moved image processing onto Kafka with a transactional outbox, and added a document upload service for KYC.
- Built a dashboard service for the merchant portal and a Zendesk ticket-enrichment service from scratch. In the HubSpot and MyFatoorah adapters, implemented merchant onboarding from a deal and multi-account payments.
- Set up engineering foundations for the unit: linters, pre-commit, CODEOWNERS and SonarQube across roughly 15 projects, end-to-end tracing through the API and Temporal workers, Sentry environments and Prometheus metrics for on-call. To improve resilience, built an Ansible-based secrets configurator in Vault for disaster recovery.
- Designed unit-level solutions: a workflow registry shared across teams, the KYC data model. Validated infrastructure decisions with practical tests before committing — after comparing a managed cloud cache with a self-hosted option, the team chose self-hosted Redis on Kubernetes. Built PoCs for production feature control via feature-flag services (Unleash) and CRDs for the API Gateway.

- Wrote OpenAPI specs myself for some services, and reviewed and discussed design decisions for the rest. Validated contracts with Stoplight, and for API-first services, where the OpenAPI document is the source of truth, covered them with contract tests using Schemathesis.

AI in development · 2025 — present

- Built a Telegram interface for the merchant AI assistant, from the design doc (OIDC via Keycloak, SSE streaming) to release, then migrated the assistant to a separate infrastructure perimeter with different data-residency requirements.
- Evaluated AI-based MR review using a test MR seeded with intentional bugs: compared qodo, kodus and my own prototype on local models. The paid agents missed bugs and gave inconsistent results across runs, so I proposed combining static analysis with parallel review of diff chunks.
- About a year of daily development with Claude Code, Cursor before that. Moved my setup to a provider-agnostic source: rules, skills, MCP and permissions live in one place (AGENTS.md), from which a tested generator builds configs for Claude Code and opencode. Measured token usage across 17 sessions and restructured my workflow around it: reading code in subagents, handoff hooks between sessions, and my own usage tracking.

Life Pay (Russia): online acquiring · 2022 — 2025

- For about 2.5 years, owned the payment links system and the SBP (Faster Payments System) Telegram bot as the original author: API v1 and v2, a client library, multi-tenancy, admin panel, metrics, support, and the track's quarterly roadmap.
- Built a service from scratch that relays card transactions into a unified merchant portal via Kafka: from message schemas to production, including a DLQ.
- Planned and ran the back-office migration from Python 2 to Python 3 and a current Django version, including moving database migrations from raw SQL to Alembic and then to Django migrations.
- Built a payment gateway service and implemented Yandex Split (BNPL) and MyFatoorah integrations in it: refunds, webhook signature verification, multi-currency support, recurring payments.
- Diagnosed and fixed: 3DS flow hangs, false payment notifications, and duplicate orders caused by messenger link-preview bots.

Stack: `Python, FastAPI, Flask, Django, SQLAlchemy, Temporal, Keycloak, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, S3, Kubernetes (EKS), GitLab CI, Vault, OpenTelemetry, Sentry, Prometheus, Grafana`

EPAM Systems · Jan 2021 — Jun 2022 (1 yr 6 mo)

Senior Software Engineer · Saint Petersburg

- Built and launched a search and metadata portal for a client from scratch: REST API on Django and FastAPI, search on Elasticsearch.
- Built microservices on AWS: ECS, Lambda, SQS, S3.
- Developed and maintained ETL pipelines on AWS Glue, S3 and PySpark.
- Owned the backend side of every feature on the project, shipping more than 10 epics and user stories.
- Introduced unit testing and code style checks (pytest, flake8) on the team, and sped up builds and deployment. Infrastructure on Terraform.

Stack: `Python, Django, FastAPI, SQLAlchemy, PySpark, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, AWS (ECS, Lambda, SQS, S3, Glue, Athena), Terraform`

JetBrains · Jun 2019 — Dec 2020 (1 yr 7 mo)
Backend Developer · Saint Petersburg

- Maintained the backend of jetbrains.com and its satellite sites on Django and Jinja: refactoring, unit tests.
- Migrated form-submission handling to an asynchronous AWS pipeline (SQS, S3, Lambda) written in Kotlin.
- Owned infrastructure and CI/CD: Terraform, TeamCity.
- Ran load testing of the site's backend in Apache JMeter.
- Reworked the Zendesk and Marketo integrations, and helped with the Crowdin integration: file merging, exporting and importing translations.

Stack: `Python, Django, Jinja, Kotlin, JavaScript, AWS, Terraform, TeamCity`

RAWG.io · Aug 2018 — May 2019 (10 mo)
Backend Developer · remote · a video game recommendation service, the "IMDb for games"

- Built the user-generated content backend: Django, PostgreSQL, Redis.
- Improved site search and filters using Elasticsearch and PostgreSQL full-text search.
- Implemented a real-time top-100 ranking.
- Owned the backend of the recommendation system, based on user-based collaborative filtering.

Stack: `Python, Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Celery, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, memcached, Docker, Ansible, Jenkins`

GOST-group · Jun 2016 — Aug 2018 (2 yr 3 mo)
Python Developer · Moscow

- Developed a web application with forms and data analytics on Django and Jinja.
- Built a Django-Admin-style admin panel for a Tornado-based project that processed and analyzed geodata.
- Wrote a Go service for parsing binary data coming from field equipment.

Stack: `Python 2.7 / 3, Django, Tornado, Go, PostgreSQL, Redis, Celery, SQLAlchemy, Ansible`

Skills

Languages
Python, SQL; some Go and Kotlin

Backend
FastAPI, Django / DRF, Flask, SQLAlchemy + Alembic, pydantic, Celery, Temporal

Data
PostgreSQL, Redis, Kafka, Elasticsearch, S3

Auth
Keycloak, OIDC, JWT, OTP

Infrastructure
Kubernetes, Docker, GitLab CI, Terraform, Vault, AWS

Observability
OpenTelemetry, Sentry, Prometheus, Grafana

Testing
pytest, Schemathesis, Stoplight, SonarQube

AI-assisted development
Claude Code, MCP, subagents, opencode, local models (Ollama)

Education

Academy of Social Management, Moscow, 2006 — 2011
Public Administration

Languages

Russian — native
English — B2

Evgenii Uvarov, updated October 2026